

Traffic Rule Summary

Sebasitan Maierhofer

March 16, 2020

1 Introduction

This document serves as an overview about formalized traffic rules based on the German Road Traffic Regulation (StVO), the Vienna Convention on Road Traffic [1] (VCoRT), judicial decisions, and comments by lawyers.

The formalization process of traffic rules in temporal logic can be separated into four steps:

1. **Extracting rules from legal sources:** Based on a traffic rule, all related rules can be extracted from legal sources. Legal sources can contain judicial decisions, other traffic law sections, and consultancy of lawyers.
2. **Concretizing extracted rules:** The legal texts and judicial decisions are combined and concretized using natural language. As part of the concretization, the situation when the rule is applicable should be expressed. It can also be the case that a single traffic rule addresses different aspects and therefore each has to be considered separately, e.g., StVO §4(1) addresses the distance between vehicles and also restricts the braking of a vehicle. The use of natural language allows lawyers to evaluate the concretization so that consistency between the formalized rules for autonomous vehicles and the traffic rules for human traffic participants can be ensured.
3. **Extracting functions, predicates, and propositions:** We use predicates, functions, and atomic propositions for the evaluation of traffic situations, e.g., the allowed speed limit or the velocity of a preceding vehicle. These elements should be defined in a modular way such that they can be easily reused.
4. **Creating temporal logic formulas:** The extracted predicates, functions, and propositions have to be combined to a temporal logic formula matching the concretized sentence from 2).

The remainder of this paper is structured as follows. Sec. 2 introduces mathematical foundations. Sec. 3 presents the formalization of traffic rules. In Sec. 4 predicates and auxiliary functions for the temporal logic formulas are defined.

2 Preliminaries

2.1 Legal information

Please note that no official translated version of the StVO exist. The translation used for this paper is based on the *German Law Archive*¹. The formalized rules in this work consider the ego vehicle as the autonomous vehicle from whose perception the rules are written. All other traffic participants can either be controlled by humans or can also be autonomous vehicles.

We assume that the considered interstates have no intersections, driving directions are structurally separated so that only lanes with the same driving direction are adjacent, and have right-hand traffic. However, our formalization can also be used for left-hand traffic. Please note that it is possible on German interstates that no speed limit exist. In the following sections, we differentiate main carriage ways, access ramps, exit ramps, and shoulder lanes as potential lane types and solid, dashed, broad solid, and broad dashed lines as possible lane markings. We consider only cars and trucks as vehicle types.

2.2 Road Network

We describe our road network by lanelets, which are atomic, drivable road segments, geometrically represented by a left and right bound, where the bounds are represented by polylines [2]. The set of all lanelets in a road network is denoted by $\mathbb{L} \cup \{\perp\}$, where $\perp$ is the bottom element for the case that no lanelet exist. Subsequently, we refer to a single lanelet as l , where $l \in \mathbb{L}$. A lanelet can be described by attributes, where the set of all attributes is denoted by $\mathbb{A}$. For interstates, we have $\mathbb{A} = \{access_ramp, exit_ramp, main_carriage_way, shoulder\}$. The function $attr(l)$ returns the attribute which is valid for a lanelet (cf. Fig. 1). Similar, the left and right bounds of a lanelet can have lanelet markings. We denote the set of possible lanelet markings as $\mathbb{LM} = \{solid, dashed, broad_solid, broad_dashed\}$. The functions $mark_l(l)$ and $mark_r(l)$ return the left and right lanelet marking of a lanelet. The functions $l_{lb}(l)$, $l_{rb}(l)$, $l_{ini}(l)$, and $l_{fin}(l)$ return the left bound, right bound, left and right initial points, and left and right final points of a lanelet. The functions

$$adj_l(l) = \begin{cases} l' & \text{if } l' \in \mathbb{L} \wedge l_{lb}(l) = l_{rb}(l') \\ \perp & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (1)$$

$$adj_r(l) = \begin{cases} l' & \text{if } l' \in \mathbb{L} \wedge l_{rb}(l) = l_{lb}(l') \\ \perp & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (2)$$

$$succ(l) = \begin{cases} l' & \text{if } l' \in \mathbb{L} \wedge l_{fin}(l) = l_{ini}(l') \\ & \wedge attr(l) = attr(l') \\ \perp & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (3)$$

$$pre(l) = \begin{cases} l' & \text{if } l' \in \mathbb{L} \wedge l_{ini}(l) = l_{fin}(l') \\ & \wedge attr(l) = attr(l') \\ \perp & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (4)$$

return the adjacent left, adjacent right, successor, and predecessor lanelet of l , respectively (cf. Fig. 1). The functions $speed_limit(ls)$ and $required_speed(ls)$, where $ls \subseteq \mathbb{L}$, return a set of maximum and minimum speed limits which a vehicle is allowed to drive on a provided set of lanelets. The functions $ori_l(l, s_1)$ and $width_l(l, s_1)$, where s_1 is a longitudinal position, return the orientation of the reference path θ_Γ and the width of a lanelet at s_1 , respectively.

¹<https://germanlawarchive.iuscomp.org/?p=1290>

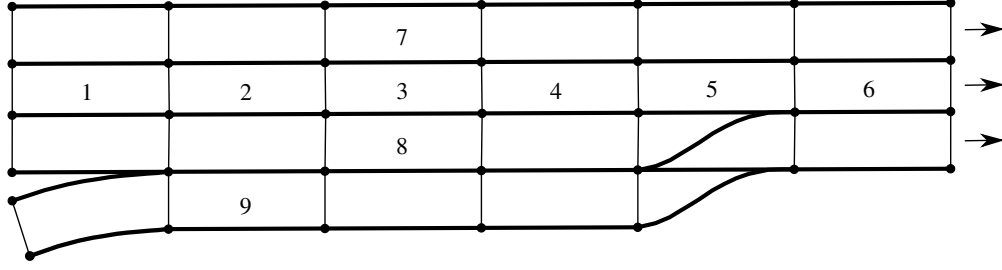


Figure 1: Road network defined by lanelets. The lanelets 1-6 form a lane. Lanelets 2, 4, 7, and 8 are the predecessor, successor, left adjacent, and right adjacent lanelet of lanelet 3, respectively. Lanelets 1-8 are of type *main_carriage_way* and lanelet 9 is of type *access_ramp*.

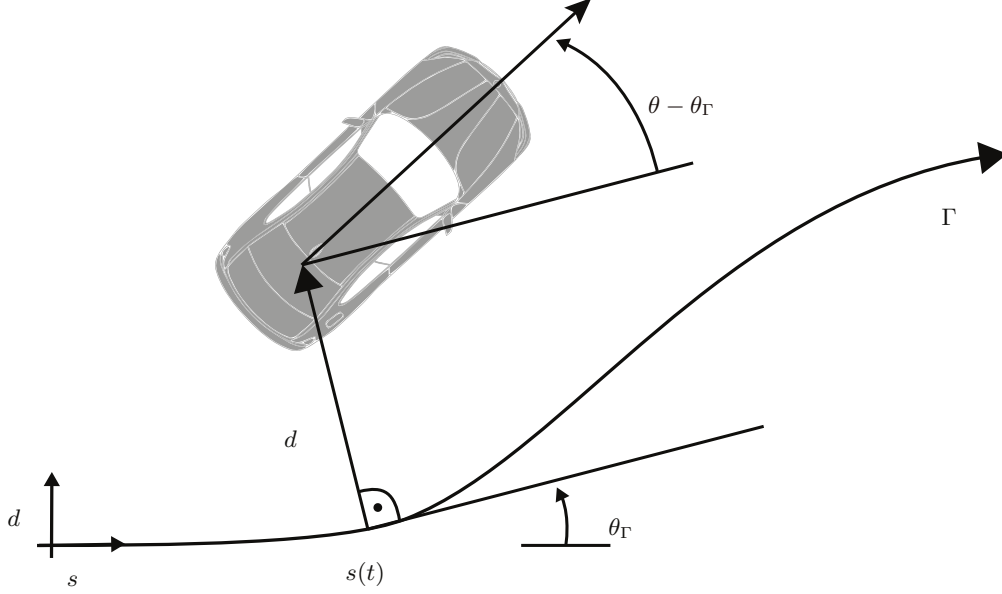


Figure 2: A curvilinear coordinate system aligned to the reference path Γ with orientation θ_Γ . The vehicle is described by the longitudinal position s , the lateral deviation of the reference path d , and the orientation θ .

Definition 1 (Lane)

The lane originating from a lanelet is defined recursively:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{lane}(l) = & \{\text{succ}(l), l, \text{pre}(l)\} \\ & \cup \text{lane}(\text{pre}(l)) \cup \text{lane}(\text{succ}(l)) \setminus \{\perp\} \end{aligned}$$

We use a curvilinear curvilinear coordinate system [3] as shown in Fig. 2.

2.3 Vehicle configuration

The state x of a vehicle consists of a longitudinal state $x_{\text{lon}} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and a lateral state $x_{\text{lat}} \in \mathbb{R}^n$. The longitudinal state $x_{\text{lon}} = [s \ v \ a \ j]^T$ consists of position s , velocity v , acceleration a , and jerk j . The lateral state $x_{\text{lat}} = [d \ \theta]^T$ consists of the lateral distance to the reference path Γ and orientation θ (cf. Fig. 2). The input of the vehicle is denoted by $u(t)$. The underlying vehicle model can be arbitrary as long as a transformation to our state representation is possible. The occupancy of a vehicle for a given state is denoted by $\mathcal{O}(x(t))$. The functions $\text{front}(x(t))$, $\text{rear}(x(t))$, $\text{right}(x(t))$, and $\text{left}(x(t))$ return the position of the front bumper, rear bumper, rightmost point and leftmost point of a vehicle and $v_{\text{type}}(x(t))$ returns the maximum allowed velocity for a vehicle type, e.g., a truck. All variables associated to the ego vehicle are denoted by the subscript $\square_{\text{ego}}$, all variables associated to other vehicles are denoted by the subscript $\square_o$, and arbitrary vehicles including the ego vehicle are denoted by the

subscript $\square_k$ and $\square_p$, where $o \in \{1 \dots N\}$, N is the number of other traffic participants, and $k, p \in \{0 \dots (N + 1)\}$ represent all vehicles in the road network including the ego vehicle. For a given initial state x_0 , an input trajectory $u(\cdot)$, we introduce the solution of the model $\dot{x} = f(x, u)$ of the ego vehicle over time t as $\xi(t; x_0, u(\cdot))$. We denote a braking input by $u_{\text{brake}}(\cdot)$. The time at which a safe state is reached for $u(\cdot)$, given the system dynamics and x_0 , is denoted by $t_s(u(\cdot))$. We consider a state to be safe on interstates for the ego vehicle if the ego vehicle is in standstill.

2.4 Finite Linear Temporal Logic

We use Finite Linear Temporal Logic (FLTL) since it is interpreted over finite traces of Boolean elements. Given is a set $\mathbb{AP}$ of atomic propositions, where each atomic proposition $\sigma_i \in \mathbb{AP}$ represents a Boolean statement. A FLTL formula ϕ is defined as

$$\begin{aligned} \phi ::= & \sigma_i \mid \neg\phi \mid \phi_1 \wedge \phi_2 \mid \phi_1 \vee \phi_2 \mid \\ & X(\phi) \mid \overline{X}(\phi) \mid \phi_1 U \phi_2 \mid G(\phi) \mid F(\phi) \end{aligned}$$

where the letter X stands for the weak next operator, $\overline{X}$ for the strong next, U for the until, G for the globally, and F for the future operator. We also require the Boolean operators $\neg$, $\wedge$, and $\vee$. Unary connectives have precedence over binary connectives, $\neg$, X , and $\overline{X}$ have equal precedence and U has precedence over $\wedge$ and $\vee$. The implication $a \implies b$ is defined as $\neg a \vee b$.

We describe the semantics of FLTL informally. For a detailed description of the semantics we refer the reader to [4] and [5]. The weak next operator expresses that if a next state exists then this state has to satisfy ϕ , whereas the strong next operator expresses that the next state has to exist and that this state has to satisfy ϕ . The until operator says that ϕ_1 is true at least until ϕ_2 is true. The globally operator states that ϕ holds at all states and the future operator states that ϕ holds at some future state.

3 Traffic rule formalization

We formalize selected rules from the StVO, e.g., establishing an emergency lane or keeping a safe distance, which are necessary to drive on German interstates and also provide their textual concretization as well as additional comments². Predicates and functions required for the FLTL formulas are introduced in Sec. 4. We first present general rules and afterward interstate-specific rules. The rules are written from the viewpoint of the autonomous ego vehicle.

3.1 General traffic rules

3.1.1 R_G1 - Safe distance to preceding vehicle

Law reference:

- **StVO §4 (1)** A person operating a vehicle moving behind another vehicle must, as a rule, keep a sufficient distance from that other vehicle so as to be able to pull up safely even if it suddenly slows down or stops. [...]
- **VCoRT §13 (5):** The driver of a vehicle moving behind another vehicle shall keep at a sufficient distance from that other vehicle to avoid collision if the vehicle in front should suddenly slow down or stop.

Concretization: The ego vehicle following vehicles within the same lane has to keep a safe distance which ensures collision freedom to each of these vehicles, even if one or several of them are suddenly stopping.

LTL formula: $G(\text{is_in_same_lane} \wedge \text{in_front_of} \implies \text{keeps_safe_distance_prec})$

Comment: The rule has to be evaluated for every other traffic participant within the sensor range. Vehicles outside are taken care of by the allowed velocity in rule R_G3. **TODO: Consider cut-in vehicles!!!**

3.1.2 R_G2 - Unnecessary braking

Law reference:

- **StVO §4 (1):** [...] The person operating the vehicle in front must not brake suddenly without a compelling reason.
- **VCoRT §17 (1):** No driver of a vehicle shall brake abruptly unless it is necessary to do so for safety reasons.

Concretization: The ego vehicle is not allowed to brake abruptly without reason. The ego vehicle brakes abruptly if: a) The ego vehicle brakes although there is no leading vehicle and there is no reason caused by a traffic regulation to reduce the velocity. b) There is an obstacle in front of the vehicle and the acceleration difference and jerk difference do not violate predefined thresholds. c) The maximum allowed speed will change or has changed due to unrecognized traffic signs or environmental conditions. All possible braking situations which are not covered by the three cases are unnecessary.

LTL formula: $G(\neg \text{unnecessary_braking})$

²The terms *OLG* and *Bay VRS* are abbreviations for German types of courts.

3.1.3 R_G3 - Maximum speed limit

Law reference:

- **StVO §3 (1):** A person operating a vehicle may only travel at a speed that allows them to be in constant control of their vehicle. In particular, they must adjust their speed to road, traffic, visibility and weather conditions as well as to their personal abilities and to the nature of their vehicle and its load. If, owing to fog, snowfall or rain, visibility is less than 50 metres, they must not travel faster than 50 km/h; where circumstances so require, they must travel at a lower speed. Their speed must be such that they can stop within their forward range of vision. However, on carriageways that are so narrow that oncoming vehicles may be endangered, they must slow down so that they are able to stop within at least half of their range of forward vision.
- **StVO §3 (4):** The maximum permissible speed for motor vehicles fitted with snow chains is 50 km/h, even in the most favourable circumstances.
- **StVO §18 (5):** On motorways within built-up areas, vehicles may travel faster than 50 km/h. On these motorways, as well as on motor roads with two carriageways separated by a central reservation or any other structures outside built-up areas, the maximum permissible speed, even under the most favorable circumstances, is: 1. 80 km/h for a) motor vehicles with a maximum authorized mass exceeding 3.5 tons, with the exception of passenger cars; b) passenger cars towing a trailer, goods vehicles towing a trailer, motor homes towing a trailer and tractor units towing a trailer; and c) buses and coaches without a trailer or towing a luggage trailer; 2. 60 km/h for a) motorcycles towing a trailer and self-propelled machines towing a trailer; b) tractor units towing two trailers; and c) buses and coaches towing a trailer or carrying passengers who have to stand because all the seats are taken; 3. 100 km/h for motor coaches and buses without a trailer: a) which, according to the entry in Part I of their registration certificate, are permitted to travel at a maximum speed of 100 km/h; b) which are constructed principally for the carriage of seated passengers and in which the passenger seats are designed as coach-style seating; c) which are fitted with seat belts on all seats and on wheelchair spaces if they are used for the carriage of wheelchair users; d) which are fitted with a speed limiter set to a maximum speed of 100 km/h (Vset); e) which meet the requirements of Directive 2001/85/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council of 20 November 2001 relating to special provisions for vehicles used for the carriage of passengers comprising more than eight seats in addition to the driver's seat, and amending Directives 70/156/EEC and 97/27/EC (OJ L 42, 13.2.2002, p. 1) in the version in force at the time of the first registration of the bus or coach in question; f) which are not fitted with regrooved tyres on their front steering axle; or g) for buses and coaches not registered in Member States of the European Union or in states parties to the Agreement on the European Economic Area if an official certificate can be presented that has been issued by the country of registration in the German language confirming compliance with the aforementioned provisions and confirming that inspections have taken place annually, the scope of which is at least that of Council Directive 96/96/EC of 20 December 1996 on the approximation of the laws of the Member States relating to roadworthiness tests for motor vehicles and their trailers (OJ L 46, 17.2.1997, p. 1), as amended.
- **StVO §18 (6):** Road users using dipped headlights on a motorway need not adjust their speed to the range of their dipped headlights if: 1. the rear lights of the motor vehicle in front are clearly visible and a sufficient distance is maintained between the vehicles; 2. it is possible to recognize in good time the course of the carriageway thanks to guiding devices provided with reflectors and, together with external light sources, to identify obstacles on the road.
- **traffic sign 274**

Concretization: The ego vehicle is not allowed to exceed the speed limit of the lanes it drives on, the speed limit which is necessary to ensure collision freedom with respect to vehicles outside the field of view, the speed which

is necessary to comfortably react to traffic regulations, the speed limit based on road conditions, and the maximum velocity which is allowed for its vehicle type.

LTL formula: $G(\text{keeps_lane_speed_limit} \wedge \text{keeps_fov_speed_limit} \wedge \text{keeps_braking_speed_limit} \wedge \text{keeps_road_condition_speed_limit} \wedge \text{keeps_type_speed_limit})$

3.1.4 R_G4 - Minimum speed limit

Law reference:

- StVO traffic sign 275:

Concretization: The ego vehicle has to consider the minimum speed limit traffic sign.

LTL formula: $G(\text{keeps_min_speed_limit})$

3.1.5 R_G5 - Traffic flow

Law reference: StVO §3 (2)

- **StVO §3 (2):** No motor vehicle must, without good reason, travel so slowly as to impede the flow of traffic.

Concretization: The ego vehicle is not allowed to travel so slowly that it impedes traffic flow.

LTL formula: $G(\text{preserves_traffic_flow})$

3.1.6 R_G6 - Zip-Merger

Law reference:

- **StVO §7 (4):** If, on roads with several lanes for one direction, uninterrupted travel in one of the lanes is not possible, or if a lane comes to an end, vehicles travelling in the adjacent lane must allow vehicles in the other lane to change lanes immediately before the road narrows, in such a way as to let them join their line of traffic in turn after each vehicle travelling in the uninterrupted lane (“zip-merging”).
- **König, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 7 StVO, recital 19:** If there is loose, traffic and vehicles arrive at the interruption with sufficient distant in accordance with StVO §4 (1) no priority conflicts will arise, as vehicles that arrive in advance can smoothly enter the uninterrupted lane. In this case, a zip-merger in the sense of StVO §7 (4) is not necessary.
- Zip merger is mandatory as soon as there is no longer sufficient distance between vehicles arriving at the interruption point in accordance with Sec. 4 StVO (LG Hanau ZfS 04, 205). This does not necessarily mean that there was traffic in queues of vehicles already before the interruption point (comp. König, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 7 StVO, recital 19). Generally, vehicles on the uninterrupted lane have the way of right before vehicles on the interrupted lane (KG Urt. v. 11.10.2010 – 12 U 148/09; KG VRS 68, 339; VM 87, 82). Lane marking or Sign 121 indicate which lane is the “uninterrupted lane”. If there are no lane markings or Sign 121, the further course of the roadway itself indicates one lane as uninterrupted lane (comp. OLG Stuttgart VRS 64, 296). The actual zip merging procedure is highly situational depending on

the circumstances. There are many unconcise variables, such as “appropriate speed” and “particular mutual care” pursuant to Sections 1 and 3 StVO, which are hard to define clearly, as they are vague, situational criteria by nature.

- How to zip merge: Vehicles driving on the interrupted lane must change to the uninterrupted lane with appropriate speed and particular care respecting the traffic on the uninterrupted lane. This basically means to comply with Par. 5. Vehicles shall arrange themselves on the uninterrupted lane at a ratio of 1 to 1 between vehicles arriving from the interrupted lane and vehicles arriving from the uninterrupted lane (comp. König, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 7 StVO, recital 20, Burmann, et. al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 7 StVO, recital 19a). However, the respective priority according to the 1 to 1 ratio must not be forced by vehicles arriving at the interruption point (KG VRS 68, 339).
- According to the Local Court Dortmund (AG Dortmund NJW 10, 2523), there is prima facie evidence against the lane changing vehicle if an accident occurs in this process. However, this is doubted by legal commentaries (comp. König, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 7 StVO, recital 20) and there are no judgements from higher courts regarding this scenario

Concretization:

Comment:

Temporal logic formula:

3.1.7 R_G7 - Driving in rightmost lane

Law reference:

- **VCoRT §10 (3):** Without prejudice to the provisions to the contrary of Article 7, paragraph 1, Article 11, paragraph 6, and to other provisions of this Convention to the contrary, every driver of a vehicle shall, to the extent permitted by circumstances, keep his vehicle near the edge of the carriageway appropriate to the direction of traffic. However, Contracting Parties or subdivisions thereof may lay down more precise rules concerning the position of goods vehicles on the carriageway.
- **VCoRT §10 (4):** Drivers shall take care that their vehicles do not inconvenience road-users or the occupants of properties bordering on the road, for example, by causing noise or raising dust or smoke where they can avoid doing so.
- **VCoRT §10 (5):** The wearing of safety belts is compulsory for drivers and passengers of motor vehicles, occupying seats equipped with such belts, save where exceptions are granted by domestic legislation.
- **VCoRT §10 (6):**

Concretization:

Comment:

Temporal logic formula:

3.1.8 R_G8 - Driving rightmost within lane

Law reference:

- **StVO §2 (2):** Drivers and riders must always keep as far to the right as possible, not only when traffic is approaching from the opposite direction, when being overtaken, when approaching the brow of a hill, on bends or when their view ahead is obstructed.
- **StVO §7 (1):** On carriageways with several lanes for one direction, motor vehicles may ignore the requirement to keep as far to the right as possible (section 2(2)) if traffic density justifies them doing so. “Lane” means that part of the carriageway which a vehicle with more than two wheels requires for travelling freely along the carriageway.

Concretization:

Comment:

Temporal logic formula:

3.1.9 R_G9 - Lane change

Law reference:

- **StVO §7 (5):** In all cases, lanes may only be changed if other road users are not endangered. Any change of lane must be signaled clearly and in good time, using the vehicle’s direction indicators to do so.
- Par. 5 describes how lanes must be changed. According to Higher Local Court Munich (dated 8.4.2011 – 10 U 5122/10) the lane change begins as soon as a vehicle drives over the road marking (comp. OLG München, Urt. v. 17.12.2004 – 10 U 3517/04; OLG Düsseldorf, Urt. v. 15.6.1977 – 5 U 231/76; Haarmann DAR 1987, 139; vgl auch OLG Hamm VersR 2001, 654). Par.5 is also applicable when traffic lanes are not marked (KG VM 86, 61). Vehicles that are about to change the lane or just partly leave their lane have to act with the utmost care (Burmahn, et. al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 7 StVO, recital 21). This means, acting in a manner where any possibility of danger for others is excluded, even in heavy traffic. Utmost care means that the driver has sufficient vision in any direction from which a danger might occur (OLG Karlsruhe VRS 78, 322). Par. 5 is not applicable when vehicles change lanes in order to overtake or to make a turn to a property.
- See VCoRT article 11

Concretization:

Comment:

Temporal logic formula:

3.2 Interstate-specific traffic rules

In the following rules for interstates which corresponds to the German Autobahn. The evaluation of the rules is activated when the traffic sign 330.1 is past and stops when the traffic sign 330.2 is past.

3.2.1 R_I1 - Stopping

Law reference:

- **StVO §12 (1):** Stopping is not permitted: [...] on acceleration and deceleration lanes; [...]
- **StVO §18 (8):** Stopping is prohibited, including on verges.
- **OLG Karlsruhe DAR 02, 34; OLG Frankfurt DAR 01, 504:** Stopping is prohibited on all parts that serve the purpose of smooth traffic.
- **OLG Hamm VersR 91, 83:** Stopping is prohibited on the emergency lane.
- **Bay VRS 59, 54 = StVE 23:** Stopping is prohibited on access lanes from and to parking spots.
- **Burmam, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 18 StVO, recital 23:** If an accident occurs, the vehicles involved must stop pursuant to StVO Sec. §11 (2) and the persons involved have to wait in order to ascertain identification.
- **OLG Köln VM 74:** Stopping on the emergency lane is only allowed temporarily and in emergency cases. Broken down cars must be removed from the emergency lane as fast as possible.

Concretization: If the ego vehicle is not part of a congestion or the directly leading vehicle is not standing, then stopping on the main carriage way, shoulder lane, and ramps is forbidden.

Comment: The last two items are currently not considered. What is in case of a congestion? standing leading vehicle? We allow the ego vehicle to stop if a leading vehicle also stops. Vehicles may stop on the marked parking areas themselves, or at the parking areas at the restaurants or gas stations.

LTL formula: $G(\neg(\text{in_congestion} \vee \text{exist_standing_leading_vehicle}) \implies \neg \text{in_standstill})$

3.2.2 R_I2 - Overtaking on the right-hand side

Law reference:

- **BGHSt 12, 258, 260:** Overtaking on the right-hand side is generally prohibited, except for the following cases.
- **StVO §7 (2):** If the density of traffic has resulted in queues of vehicles in the lanes of one carriageway, traffic on the right (nearside lane, middle lane) may move faster than traffic on the left (offside lane, middle lane).
- **StVO §7 (2a)h:** If, on a carriageway for one direction of traffic, a vehicle queue has formed and come to a standstill or is moving at low speed in the left-hand lane, vehicles may overtake this queue on the right at a slightly higher speed and with the utmost care.
- **StVO §7a (1):** Where lanes diverge from the main carriageway, especially on motorways and motor roads, vehicles turning off may, from the beginning of and to the right of a lane marking with broad lines (sign 340), travel faster than traffic on the main carriageway.
- **StVO §7a (2):** On motorways and other roads outside built-up areas, vehicles may travel faster in acceleration lanes than traffic on the main carriageway.
- **StVO §7a (3):** In deceleration lanes, vehicles must not travel faster than traffic on the main carriageway. If traffic on the main carriageway is moving slowly or is stationary, vehicles in a deceleration lane may overtake at a moderate speed and with great care.

- **OLG Frankfurt/M. VRS 63, 386; OLG Düsseldorf VRS 78, 473:** In the range of guiding signs, e.g. sign 448, if vehicles turn right and keep their lane when turning.

Concretization: The ego vehicle is not allowed to drive faster than any vehicle on lanes left of it. An exception is, if a) the vehicle in a left lane is in a congestion; b) the vehicle in the left lane is in a congestion on the main carriage way and the ego vehicle is on an off ramp; c) the left vehicle and the ego vehicle are separated by a broad lane marking; d) the ego vehicle is within an access ramp; d) the ego vehicle is close to a guiding sign and follows the guiding sign. For a) and b), the ego vehicle is allowed to drive faster than the vehicle in the left lane with only a slightly higher speed.

Comment: The second case of R_I2 is covered in the first clause of the following FLTL formula. The fourth case of R_I2 allows to drive on access ramps with higher speed than on the main carriage way. However, if a congestion is on the left side of the ego vehicle and the ego vehicle is on an access ramp, it is only allowed to drive with slightly higher speed. This rule has to be evaluated with respect to every other vehicle within the sensor range. Low speed means in this context a maximum speed of 60 km/h (comp. Burmann, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, StVO §(5) , recital 58) and slightly higher speed means 20 km/h faster than vehicles on the left lanes (BGHSt 22, 137; Bay 77, 172 = VRS 54, 212; OLG Köln VRS 61, 45). **We currently do not consider the exception for guiding signs.** The rule has to be evaluated for every other traffic participant within the sensor range.

LTL formula: $G((is_left_of \wedge drives_faster_than_vehicle_left) \implies (congestion_left \wedge drives_with_slightly_higher_speed) \vee (right_of_broad_lane_marking \wedge left_of_broad_lane_marking) \vee (on_access_ramp \wedge \neg in_congestion))$

3.2.3 R_I3 - No reversing and turning

Law reference:

- **StVO §18 (7):** Making U-turns and reversing are prohibited.

Concretization: Making U-turns and reversing is prohibited.

Comment: U-turns and reversing is prohibited for all lane types (comp. Bay VM 80, 47; OLG Hamm VRS 59, 458). U-turning can be justified in exceptional circumstances, e.g. colliding with another vehicle at night (BGH VersR 60, 802; VRS 14, 89) or being the safest means of the averting of dangers. Reversing can exceptionally be justified as an emergency measure, e.g., while losing an item of luggage (comp. Burmann, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, StVO §(18), recital 21).

LTL formula: $G(\neg makes_u_turn \wedge \neg reverses)$

3.2.4 R_I4 - Emergency lane

Law reference:

- **StVO §11 (2) - English:** As soon as vehicles on motorways and roads outside a built-up area with at least two lanes for one direction start to move at walking pace or come to a standstill, these vehicles must leave a gap for one direction between the lane on the far left and the lane immediately adjacent to it on the right to allow police and emergency vehicles to pass.

Concretization: A vehicle in a congestion has to drive leftmost if it is in the leftmost lane and has to drive rightmost otherwise. If the interstate is not broad enough to create an emergency lane, all vehicles should drive in the rightmost lane.

LTL formula: $G(\text{in_congestion} \implies ((\text{interstate_broad_enough} \implies ((\text{in_leftmost_lane} \implies \text{drives_leftmost}) \wedge (\neg \text{in_leftmost_lane} \implies \text{drives_rightmost})))) \wedge (\neg \text{interstate_broad_enough} \implies \text{drives_rightmost})))$

Comment: A situation on motorways or roads outside build-up areas, where vehicles move at walking pace with less than 10 km/h / come to a standstill for at least one minute and such standstill occurs frequently shall be referred to hereinafter as traffic jam. . A situation on motorways or roads outside build-up areas, where vehicles move slowly with less than 30 kilometres per hour 6 or stand still and such standstill occurs merely occasionally shall be referred to hereinafter as Slow-Moving Traffic (<https://www.astra.admin.ch/astra/de/home/themen/nationalstrassen/verkehrsfluss-staueaufkommen/definitionen.html>). Slow-moving traffic implies no emergency lane creation, only stillstand and driving in walking pace (comp. Burmann, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 11 StVO, recital 3; König, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 11 StVO , recital 9). The space created has to be sufficient to allow police and emergency vehicles to pass and arrive at the accident site without obstruction (comp. König, et al., Straßenverkehrsrecht, § 11 StVO, recital 9). Using the hard shoulder (Standstreifen) is prohibited, see Sec. 18 Par. 8 StVO.

3.2.5 R_I5 - Consider entering vehicles

Law reference:

- StVO §1 (2)
- StVO §18 recital 11

Concretization: The ego vehicle is not allowed to move from the main carriage way to the rightmost lane if another vehicle is about to enter the main carriage way from the access ramp.

LTL formula: $G(\text{on_access_ramp} \wedge F(\text{on_main_carriage_way}) \implies \neg(\neg \text{in_rightmost_lane} \wedge F(\text{in_rightmost_lane})))$

4 Predicates and Functions

The predicates and functions necessary to describe the presented traffic rules are categorized in position, velocity, braking, and general elements. We use first-order logic to define the predicates and functions (where the atomic propositions of the FLTL formulas correspond to the defined predicates).

4.1 Position Elements

The occupied lanelets of a state x_k are defined by the intersection of its occupancy with the corresponding lanelets:

$$\text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k) = \{l \in \mathbb{L} \mid l \cap \mathcal{O}(x_k) \neq \emptyset\}.$$

The lanes which a vehicle occupies are defined as:

$$\text{lanes}(x_k) = \{\text{lane}(l) \mid l \in (\text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k))\}.$$

This information is used to reason whether the k^{th} vehicle is in any lane the p^{th} vehicle is in:

$$\text{is_in_same_lane}(x_k, x_p) \iff \text{lanes}(x_k) \cap \text{lanes}(x_p) \neq \emptyset.$$

The k^{th} vehicle is in front of the p^{th} vehicle if its longitudinal position is larger than the one of the p^{th} vehicle:

$$\text{in_front_of}(x_p, x_k) \iff \text{front}(x_p) \leq \text{rear}(x_k).$$

The information whether a vehicle is on a the main carriage way, is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \text{on_main_carriage_way}(x_k) \iff \\ \text{main_carriage_way} \in \\ \{\text{attr}(l) \mid l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k)\}. \end{aligned}$$

Other lanelet attributes can be evaluated similarly. The k^{th} vehicle is left of the p^{th} vehicle if

$$\begin{aligned} \text{vehicle_is_left}(x_k, x_p) \iff \\ (\text{rear}(x_p) \leq \text{rear}(x_k) \leq \text{front}(x_p) \\ \vee (\text{front}(x_p) < \text{front}(x_k) \wedge \text{rear}(x_k) < \text{rear}(x_p)) \\ \vee \text{rear}(x_p) \leq \text{front}(x_k) \leq \text{front}(x_p)) \wedge d_k > d_p, \end{aligned}$$

evaluates to true. To determine whether a vehicle is right of a broad lane marking, the following predicate is introduced:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{right_of_broad_lane_marking}(x_k) \iff \\ \{l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k) \mid \text{mark}_r(l) \in \{\text{broad_solid}, \\ \text{broad_dashed}\}\} = \emptyset \wedge \\ \{l \in \text{lanelets_left_of_vehicle}(x_k) \mid \\ \text{mark}_r(l) \in \{\text{broad_solid}, \text{broad_dashed}\}\} \neq \emptyset, \end{aligned}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \text{lanelets_left_of_vehicle}(x_k) = \\ \bigcup \{\text{lanelets_left_of_lanelet}(l) \mid l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k)\}, \end{aligned}$$

returns the set containing all lanelets left of the vehicle and the recursively defined function

$$\begin{aligned} \text{lanelets_left_of_lanelet}(l) = \\ \{ \text{adj}_l(l) \} \cup \text{lanelets_left_of_lanelet}(\text{adj}_l(l)), \end{aligned}$$

returns all lanelets left of a given lanelet, where $\text{lanelets_left_of_lanelet}(\perp) = \emptyset$. Similarly, the predicates $\text{left_of_broad_lane_marking}$, $\text{lanelets_right_of_vehicle}$, and $\text{lanelets_right_of_lanelet}$ can be defined. The width of a road given a lanelet and longitudinal position s_k is recursively defined as:

$$\text{road_width}(l, s_k) = \sum_{l' \in \text{adj_lanelets}(l)} \text{width}_l(l', s_k)$$

where $\text{road_width}(\perp, s_k) = 0$ and

$$\begin{aligned} \text{adj_lanelets}(l) = (\{l\} \cup \text{adj_lanelets}(\text{adj}_r(l)) \\ \cup \text{adj_lanelets}(\text{adj}_l(l))) \setminus \{\perp\}. \end{aligned}$$

If the width of a road is larger than a certain threshold $w_{\text{lane}}^{\min}$, the road is declared as broad enough:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{interstate_broad_enough}(x_k) \iff \\ \forall l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k) : \text{road_width}(l, s_k) > w_{\text{lane}}^{\min}. \end{aligned}$$

A vehicle is in the leftmost lane if any of its occupied lanelets has no left adjacent lanelet:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{in_leftmost_lane}(x_k) \iff \\ \exists l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k) : \text{adj}_l(l) = \perp. \end{aligned}$$

The proposition in_rightmost_lane for the rightmost lane is defined analogously. To evaluate if a vehicle drives as leftmost or as rightmost as possible, the lateral distance from the lane center and the lane width are used:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{drives_leftmost}(x_k, s_k) \iff \forall l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k) : \\ \left(\frac{1}{2} \text{width}_l(l, s_k) + \text{left}(x_k) \right) \leq d_{\text{bound}}, \end{aligned}$$

where drives_rightmost is analogously defined.

4.2 Velocity Elements

The speed limit regulated by traffic signs is the minimum speed limit of all lanelets a vehicle occupies:

$$v_{\text{sl}}^{\max}(x_k) = \min(\text{speed_limit}(\text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k))).$$

Similar, the minimum speed limit is defined as:

$$v_{\text{sl}}^{\min}(x_k) = \max(\text{required_speed}(\text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k))).$$

The ego vehicle has to be able to stop within the field of view. Therefore, the maximum allowed velocity based on the field of view v_{fov} is chosen such that the ego vehicle can come safely to a standstill even when a standing vehicle enters the field of view fov . For this, we search for the maximum value of v_{fov} which fulfills the following condition:

$$\text{front}(\xi(t_s(u_{\text{brake}}(\cdot)); x_{\text{lon}}^{\text{sr}}, u_{\text{brake}}(\cdot))) \leq fov,$$

where $x_{\text{lon}}^{\text{sr}} = [0, v_{\text{fov}}, a_{\text{ego}}^{\text{max}}, j_{\text{ego}}^{\text{max}}]^T$ is the worst-case initial state. Additionally, the ego vehicle has to reduce its velocity to an upcoming speed limit such that it does not brake abruptly. Therefore, the speed limit v_{br} is introduced which ensures that a trajectory for the velocity reduction exists which does not exceed a predefined acceleration threshold $a_{\text{abrupt}} < 0$ and jerk threshold $j_{\text{abrupt}} < 0$. We calculate v_{br} analogously to v_{fov} , where the following two conditions have to be fulfilled:

$$\begin{aligned} x_{\text{lon}}^{\text{f}} &= \xi(t^*; x_{\text{lon}}^0, u(\cdot)), \\ \forall t \in [t_0, t^*] : a_{\text{ego}}(t) &\geq a_{\text{abrupt}} \wedge j_{\text{ego}}(t) \geq j_{\text{abrupt}}, \end{aligned}$$

where $x_{\text{lon}}^0 = [0, v_{\text{br}}, a_{\text{ego}}^{\text{max}}, j_{\text{ego}}^{\text{max}}]^T$ and $x_{\text{lon}}^{\text{f}} = [fov, v_{\text{sl}}^*, 0, 0]^T$ are the worst-case initial state and the final state at which the upcoming speed limit v_{sl}^* is reached. Additionally, we assume that the ego vehicle has to consider the maximum allowed velocity v_{w} based on the road conditions for which we assume that it is externally provided. A vehicle keeps the speed limit given by traffic signs if its velocity is less than $v_{\text{sl}}^{\text{max}}$:

$$\text{keeps_lane_speed_limit}(x_k, v_k) \iff v_k \leq v_{\text{sl}}^{\text{max}}(x_k).$$

The other speed limit predicates are defined analogously. A vehicle only needs to consider the minimum required speed limit if its velocity is below v_{fov} , v_{w} , and v_{type} :

$$\begin{aligned} \text{keeps_min_speed_limit}(x_k, v_k) &\iff \\ v_{\text{sl}}^{\text{min}}(x_k) < \min(v_{\text{fov}}, v_{\text{w}}, v_{\text{type}}) &\implies v_{\text{sl}}^{\text{min}}(x_k) \leq v_k. \end{aligned}$$

To ensure high traffic throughput on interstates, vehicles must not impede traffic flow:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{preserves_traffic_flow}(x_k, v_k) &\iff \\ \neg \text{slow_leading_vehicle} &\implies v_{\text{max1}}(x_k) - v_k > \Delta v_{\text{fl}}, \end{aligned}$$

where $v_{\text{max1}}(x_k) = \min(v_{\text{br}}, v_{\text{fov}}, v_{\text{w}}, v_{\text{sl}}^*(x_k), v_{\text{type}}(x_k))$,

$$v_{\text{sl}}^*(x_k) = \begin{cases} v_{\text{sl}}^{\text{max}}(x_k) & \text{if } v_{\text{sl}}^{\text{max}}(x_k) \neq \text{inf}, \\ v_{\text{su}} & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

v_{su} is the suggested velocity which is assumed if no speed limit is present,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{slow_leading_vehicle}(x_k) &\iff \\ \exists o \in \{1 \dots N\} : v_{\text{max2}}(x_o) - v_o &> \Delta v_{\text{fl}} \\ \wedge \text{is_in_same_lane}(x_k, x_o) \wedge \text{in_front_of}(x_k, x_o), \end{aligned}$$

$v_{\text{max2}}(x_k) = \min(v_{\text{w}}, v_{\text{sl}}^*(x_k), v_{\text{type}}(x_k))$, and Δv_{fl} is a threshold which indicates if a vehicle drives slowly. A vehicle is in standstill if its velocity is close to zero:

$$\text{in_standstill}(v_k) \iff -v_{\text{err}} \leq v_k \leq v_{\text{err}},$$

where v_{err} captures measurement uncertainties and is close to zero. This predicate can be used to evaluate if leading vehicles exist which are standing:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{exist_standing_leading_vehicle}(x_k) &\iff \\ \exists o \in \{1 \dots N\} : \text{is_in_same_lane}(x_k, x_o) & \\ \wedge \text{in_front_of}(x_k, x_o) \wedge \text{in_standstill}(x_o). \end{aligned}$$

The k^{th} vehicle drives with slightly higher speed than the p^{th} vehicle if the following predicate is true:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{drives_with_slightly_higher_speed}(x_k, x_p) &\iff \\ 0 < x_k - x_p < v_{\text{so}}, \end{aligned}$$

where v_{so} indicates slightly higher speed. The following proposition indicates that k^{th} vehicle drives faster than any vehicle on its left side:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{drives_faster_than_vehicle_left}(v_k) &\iff \\ \exists o \in \{1 \dots N\} : \text{vehicle_is_left}(x_o) \wedge v_k > v_o. \end{aligned}$$

A backward driving vehicle has a negative velocity considering uncertainties:

$$\text{reverses}(v_k) \iff v_k < -v_{\text{err}}.$$

4.3 Braking Elements

The safe distance which has to be kept by the ego vehicle to a leading vehicle is based on the definitions in [6] and [7]:

$$d_{\text{safe}}(v_{\text{ego}}, v_o) = \frac{v_o^2}{2a_o^{\min}} - \frac{v_r^2}{2a_{\text{ego}}^{\min}} + v_{\text{ego}}t_d + \frac{1}{2}a_{\text{ego}}^{\max}t_d^2,$$

where $v_r = v_{\text{ego}} + a_{\text{ego}}^{\max}t_d$ and t_d denotes the reaction time of the ego vehicle. We assume that other vehicles can brake stronger than the ego vehicle: $a_o^{\min} < a_{\text{ego}}^{\min}$. The safe distance is kept if the relative distance between the vehicles is larger than the safe distance:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{keeps_safe_distance_prec}(x_{\text{ego}}, x_o, v_{\text{ego}}, v_o) &\iff \\ d_{\text{safe}}(v_{\text{ego}}, v_o) &< (\text{rear}(x_o) - \text{front}(x_{\text{ego}})). \end{aligned}$$

Unnecessary braking is defined based on the ego vehicle's acceleration and jerk:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{unnecessary_braking}(x_{\text{ego}}, a_{\text{ego}}) &\iff \\ a_{\text{ego}} < 0 &\implies (\nexists o \in \{1 \dots N\} : \text{in_front_of}(x_k, x_o) \\ &\wedge a_{\text{ego}} < a_{\text{abrupt}}) \vee (\exists o \in \{1 \dots N\} : \\ &\text{in_front_of}(x_k, x_o) \wedge (a_{\text{ego}} - a_o) < a_{\text{abrupt}}), \end{aligned}$$

We assume this information is provided by another system. **Allow violation of rule if safe distance is violated.**

4.4 General Elements

The k^{th} vehicle is part of a congestion if there is a predefined number of slow driving vehicles in front of it:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{in_congestion}(x_k) &\iff \\ \exists^{n_{\text{con}}} o \in \{1 \dots N\} : \text{in_front_of}(x_k, x_o) \\ &\wedge \text{is_in_same_lane}(x_o) \wedge v_o \leq v_{\text{con}}, \end{aligned}$$

where v_{con} indicates slow moving vehicles in a congestion and n_{con} is the minimum required number of vehicles which are part of a congestion within one lane. A congestion is left of a vehicle if some vehicle on the left side is in a congestion:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{congestion_left}(x_k) &\iff \\ \exists o \in \{1 \dots N\} : \text{vehicle_is_left}(x_k, x_o) \\ &\wedge \text{in_congestion}(x_k). \end{aligned}$$

For a turning vehicle the difference between the vehicle's orientation and the reference path orientation violates a threshold θ_{turn} :

$$\begin{aligned} \text{makes_u_turn}(x_k) &\iff \\ \exists l \in \text{occupied_lanelets}(x_k) : \theta_{\text{turn}} &< |\theta_k - \text{ori}_l(l, s_k)|. \end{aligned}$$

References

- [1] United Nations Economic Commission for Europe, “Convention on road traffic,” United Nations Conference on Road Traffic, 1968, (consolidated version of 2006). [Online]. Available: https://www.unece.org/fileadmin/DAM/trans/conventn/Conv_road_traffic_EN.pdf
- [2] P. Bender, J. Ziegler, and C. Stiller, “Lanelets: Efficient map representation for autonomous driving,” in *Proc. of the IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium*, 2014, pp. 420–425.
- [3] E. Héry, S. Masi, P. Xu, and P. Bonnifait, “Map-based curvilinear coordinates for autonomous vehicles,” in *Proc. of the IEEE Int. Conf. on Intelligent Transportation Systems*, 2018, pp. 1–7.
- [4] Z. Manna and A. Pnueli, *Temporal Verification of Reactive Systems: Safety*. Springer, New York, 1995.
- [5] A. Bauer, M. Leucker, and C. Schallhart, “Comparing LTL semantics for runtime verification,” *Journal of Logic and Computation*, vol. 20, no. 3, pp. 651–674, 2010.
- [6] C. Pék, P. Zahn, and M. Althoff, “Verifying the safety of lane change maneuvers of self-driving vehicles based on formalized traffic rules,” in *Proc. of the IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium*, 2017, pp. 1477–1483.
- [7] A. Rizaldi, F. Immler, and M. Althoff, “A formally verified checker of the safe distance traffic rules for autonomous vehicles,” in *Proc. of the NASA Formal Methods Symposium*, 2016, pp. 175–190.